somewhat hesitant, is a reassertion of the historical trend.

What then can be described as an Indian world view? What is the template that influences India's relationship with the rest of the world? The answers to these questions will sum up this chapter.

One, there is an immemorial and abiding sense of affinity drawn from a geography cosmic in origin but reflected in the physical attributes of the subcontinent. This is intrinsic to the sense of being Indian and is anchored in the geography of the subcontinent. This sense of affinity is overlaid by a modern nationalism but has echoes of the mental map inherited from the past. Overcoming the fragmentation of this historical and cultural space is the challenge. The idea of making the subcontinent whole again is a powerful driver of India's foreign policy behaviour.

Two, India's location at the intersection of major caravan and maritime routes in the past has afforded a certain innate cosmopolitan outlook and comfort in dealing with diverse cultures and peoples. Its embrace of pluralism is deeply rooted, almost instinctive, and this is an asset in an increasingly globalized world.

Three, India will reach out along the very same remembered pathways traced by its history – extending to the eastern and western reaches of the Indian Ocean and to the Central Asian neighbourhood to the north and west – as its economic and security capabilities expand. In Central Asia, India still echoes in the cultures of the erstwhile states of the former Soviet Union and Afghanistan, where Indian traders and Buddhist missionaries have left their imprint upon the mountain and desert landscapes. To the west, Indian influence radiates along the Gulf and the eastern seaboard of Africa. To the east, India will retrace its historical footsteps to South East Asia, the eastern coast of China and as far as Japan. Beyond the subcontinent, all this is India's extended neighbourhood.

[1] Diana Eck, *India: A Sacred Geography,* Harmony, 2012.

The *asvamedha* sacrifice involved letting loose a royal horse and claiming for the king the territory it covered uncontested or the lands in its path that were under local rulers who surrendered to the overlordship of the king. If any ruler resisted the king's army was at hand to subdue him. On the Mughal fascination with *chakravartin* and the *asvamedha* ritual, see Audrey Truschke, *Culture of Encounters: Sanskrit at the Mughal Court* , Allen Lane, 2016.